

ZERO-TO-100T SETUP GUIDE

OX ALPHA

From "I have never opened a terminal" to running a free frontier-class AI coding agent — in about 15 minutes. No Node.js installed? Perfect. This guide starts from absolute zero, on macOS and Windows.

\$0

COST FOR USING

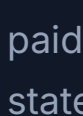
1M

TOKEN CONTEXT

100T

TOKENS / DAY CAPACITY

01 The Briefing — What You’re Setting Up

 **Ox Alpha**

Ox Alpha is the anonymous "stealth" model that appeared on Aug 20, 2026 and immediately started trading blows with paid frontier flagships: **1M-token context**, **text + image + video input**, always-on reasoning — served free at a stated capacity of 100 trillion tokens per day.

 **OpenCode**

OpenCode is the free, open-source AI coding agent that runs in your terminal and gives you Ox Alpha at **\$0**. You type what you want in plain English; it writes the files, runs the commands, and fixes its own mistakes.

ALL YOU NEED A computer (macOS or Windows) · an internet connection · ~15 minutes. **Zero coding experience required.** Seriously.

PATH A

2-Minute Taste (No Install)

Try it in your browser first — no terminal, no install, zero friction.

- Go to [openRouter.ai](#) and create a free account (Google sign-in works).
- In the model search bar, type **"Ox Alpha"** — or paste the exact model ID below.

`stealth/ox-alpha`

Hit the Chat / playground tab and talk to it. That's the mystery model, free, right in the browser.

Path A is a taste. The real magic — the agent that builds entire projects for you — is Path B.

PATH B

Real Setup (4 Steps)

02 Step 1 — Install Node.js (The Engine)

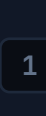
Node.js is the free runtime OpenCode needs to exist on your machine. It's official, safe, and comes from one place only: **nodejs.org**. Pick your system below.

 **macOS**

- Open Safari or Chrome and go to **nodejs.org**.
- Click the big green LTS download — you'll get a .pkg file.
- Open it and click Continue > Install (enter your Mac password if asked).
- Open Terminal: press Cmd + Space, type Terminal, hit Enter.
- Verify — type this and press Enter:

`$ node -v`

Should reply with a version like **v22.x.x**. That's a win.

 **Windows**

- Open your browser and go to **nodejs.org**.
- Download the LTS installer — you'll get a .msi file.
- Run it. Keep every default. Next > Next > Install > Finish.
- Open PowerShell: Windows key, type PowerShell, hit Enter.
- Verify — type this and press Enter:

`$ node -v`

A version like **v22.x.x** means you're good.

 **IF IT SAYS "NODE IS NOT RECOGNIZED"**

Close the terminal window completely and open a brand-new one. On Windows, one restart of the PC also fixes it. Installers only update new windows — old ones never learn.

03 Step 2 — Install OpenCode (One Command)

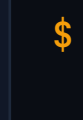
Same command on macOS and Windows. In the terminal, type this and press Enter — it downloads for about a minute.

TERMINAL — MACOS & WINDOWS

`$ npm install -g opencode-ai`

VERIFY INSTALL

`$ opencode --version`
should print the version number

 **macOS Extras** — only if you already use these tools

```
# Homebrew users
$ brew install sst/tap/opencode

# or the official script
$ curl -fsSL https://opencode.ai/install | bash
```

03 Step 3 — Make a Playground & Launch

Give the agent an empty room to build in. Type these three lines, pressing Enter after each:

1

`$ mkdir ox-playground`
makes a new folder

2

`$ cd ox-playground`
steps inside it

3

`$ opencode`
launches the agent

GOOD TO KNOW

OpenCode is open source and free. It can read and edit files only inside the folder you launched it from — which is exactly why we made an empty playground. It sandboxes itself to your project directory.

04 Step 4 — Sign In & Unlock Ox Alpha

1

Inside OpenCode, run the auth command — your browser opens automatically; create the free OpenCode account:

`> opencode auth login`

2

Back in the terminal, open the model picker:

`> /models`

3

Select **"Ox Alpha Free"** from the list. It can appear under a preview alias — always pick from the list instead of typing a model ID from a screenshot.

 **That's the whole setup. You're now chatting with the 100T-tokens-a-day mystery model, for exactly \$0.**

PROMPTS Your First 3 Prompts — Copy These

> 01

"Build a one-page personal portfolio website for me. Dark theme, modern, my name is _____. Create all the files."

> 02

"Look at every file in this folder and explain what each one does like I'm 12 years old."

> 03

"(attach any screenshot) Recreate this exact UI in HTML and CSS, then improve it."

Pro tips: It accepts images and video, so feed it screenshots of bugs or screen recordings of broken flows. The 1M context means it can hold an entire project in its head — so give it big, multi-step jobs. That's what it was built for.

05 Field Fixes — When Something Breaks

 **"node is not recognized"**

Open a brand-new terminal window. On Windows, one restart also fixes it.

 **"opencode: command not found"**

Close the terminal, open a fresh one, try again.

 **Permission error (EACCES) on Mac**

Rerun the install as: `sudo npm install -g opencode-ai`

 **Model stops mid-task at peak hours**

Update: `npm update -g opencode-ai` — v1.18.21+ auto-retries interrupted runs.

 **Ox Alpha missing from /models**

Sign in first (`opencode auth login`) — it lives in the free tier after login.

 **ONE HONEST WARNING**

Nobody knows who runs this model yet. So: don't paste passwords, API keys, client work, or your company's private code into it. Side projects, learning, experiments, portfolio builds — go absolutely wild.

You're now running a frontier mystery model.

For \$0.

Build something. Tag me — I repost the best ones.

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